

Seunghu Kim

Urban Designer based in London, UK

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• Introduction

I have a keen eye for viewing cities through both a scientific and philosophical lens. This enables me to navigate technical realities while having human empathy in my work as an urban designer. From designing intimate moments to framing a narrative, this is the driver of my everyday work, standing on that intersection.

Ultimately, my goal is to create places of lasting value—environments that don't just exist but improve as they age, and projects that don't just solve today's problems but remain resilient as the world changes. Embracing flux over permanence.

• Education

Master of Science - Architecture and Urban Design (May 2025)

Columbia University - New York, NY

"Deproblematizing Flooding by Problematizing the Waterfront" [Conflict Urbanism 2025](#)

"Saemaul Undong: South Korea's New Village Movement", Public Space

"How to Break a City?", [URBAN Magazine Vol.35](#), pp. 57-60

Bachelor of Architecture (May 2024)

The University of Arizona - Tucson, AZ

ARC 410F Design Excellence - [Honorable Mention](#)

Member of National Organization of Minority Architects

Vice-President of the Korean Student Association

Summer Architecture Study Abroad - Italy (Led by Teresa Rosano)

• Scholarships & Awards

Columbia University (2024)

Merit-based Scholarship

Merit-based Scholarship funding is limited and awards are competitive, prioritizing students who have demonstrated the highest level of academic achievement. Selections were made based on faculty review of the application materials within each academic program.

The University of Arizona (2024)

Research & Innovation Capstone Award

[This award](#) honors work that best exemplifies José Ortega y Gasset's idea of life as self-invention—a project rooted in research, imagination, and methodology. It must clearly test a hypothesis related to building, dwelling, and thinking. Nominated and voted by faculty.

U.S. Department of Energy (2024)

Solar Decathlon - 3rd Place

At the National Renewable Energy Laboratory (NREL) in Golden, CO, our team, Casa Verde, [placed third in the Attached Housing Division](#) of a competition recognizing innovation in high-performance, energy-efficient housing with technical excellence and sustainability.

• Work Experience

Urban Designer (January 2026 - Present)

Prior + Partners - London, UK

Working on the [Birmingham Sports Quarter](#), a major sports-led regeneration masterplan centred on a new stadium designed by Heatherwick Studio alongside residential, commercial, arena, sports, hotel and university uses. Working across urban design and large-scale masterplanning in collaboration with a multidisciplinary consultant team including Deloitte, WSP, Field Operations, Buro Happold, Speirs Major, Arcadis and Greengage.

[Sports-led Regeneration Masterplan](#)

Research Assistant (October 2025 - Present)

Open DMZ Lab ([axu studio](#)) - Remote

Researching projects and spatial narratives around the Korean Demilitarized Zone (DMZ) while contributing to an ongoing publication that reinterprets the region beyond a conventional project catalogue. The publication synthesizes diverse forms of representation—including satellite imagery, models and exhibitions—to construct alternative ways of reading and understanding the DMZ.

[Research & Editorial Strategy](#) [Publication Development](#)

Associate II (June 2025 - August 2025)

Columbia University GSAPP - New York, USA

Organized [studio](#) activities and participate in design critiques to support student projects. Actively participate in design critiques by providing constructive feedback to support the development of student projects. Assist in preparing and reviewing conceptual and detailed design proposals

[Urban Design Strategy](#) [Studio Coordination](#)

Architectural Intern (June 2023 - July 2023) / (December 2022 - January 2023)

Jacobs - Seoul, South Korea

Experience in effective project management was gained through collaboration with the Architectural Lead on multiple large-scale projects with USACE, gaining insight through government related projects, especially working with different stakeholders and dealing with funding challenges.

[Project Management](#) [Large-Scale Planning](#)

Designer (June 2020 - June 2021)

Samik Building Materials - Seoul, South Korea

Transforming technical knowledge of building materials into compelling visual narratives by creating diverse medium to [showcase architectural qualities](#) and [crafting storytelling](#) for marketing and design communication.

[Visual Storytelling](#) [Media Strategy](#)

• Software Proficiency

GIS - Rhino - Illustrator / Evident-based Modeling + Visualization

Generative AI - Photoshop / AI-assisted Rendering + Prompt Engineering

Houdini - Python / Procedural Urban Analysis Workflow

Autodesk Forma(ACC) / BIM 2.0